

Looking at this painting, "Troubled Island" I believe it is both art and craft. What caught my attention was the contrast between the deep red background and the greyscale figures in the foreground. To me it created a story of visual tension before you understand the entire picture. Looking at the figures and their painful expressions feel like they carry real emotions and burdens which are significant in telling the story. The artist is telling a story of enslavement, resistance, and liberation, moving left to right with the lightning bolt at the center acting as a point of rupture between the two. To me personally it says that history is not something that resolves cleanly.

I do not think AI could produce something of equal meaning. It could replicate the composition and the visual style as AI converges past pieces of art. However the meaning in this piece comes from a specific history and a deliberate choice to represent it the way it is by the artist.

For software I think the best code has both art and craft in it. Craft is making it work correctly and efficiently, it works well functionally and without problem. Art is making it clean and readable enough that someone else can follow your thinking without needing a comment on every line. To make my code like this, it's important to go back after it works and refactor. I ensure all the parts that are needed are present, then work on methods to resolve readability. In my opinion software should be art and craft. Craft without art produces code that functions but becomes a burden to maintain or work on after some time. Art without craft produces something that looks clean but fails under real conditions. But with both the project and code works, well, is modular, and can be scalable without significant problems.